



Fall Engineering Career Fair hosted by SWE/TBP
September 14-15, 2025 | 10 am - 4 pm ET

Welcome to the 2026 Career Fair Guide!

Tau Beta Pi and the Society of Women Engineers are excited to present the 2026 Fall Engineering Career Fair. Here you will find a guide for everything—from preparing for the fair to what to do after the fair.

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Before the Career Fair

- **Research and know details about companies beforehand:** for each company you're interested in, know what roles they're looking for and what the company's objectives are. Also, know what the company has been doing as of late—read the recent news and potentially use it in your conversation if you get the chance!
- **Apply to the positions you're interested in NOW:** this shows recruiters that you've already taken initiative.
- **Use LinkedIn:** find other students who have worked there already and reach out with any questions. Chances are they'd be happy to set up a quick call!
- **Elevator pitch:** write an elevator pitch (more details on Page 5) to introduce yourself with.
- **Use the ECRC company filter:** filter companies based on major. Don't skip smaller companies just because you don't recognize the name! Lines will likely be shorter, and they might even have roles that are more aligned with your interests. Link coming soon!
- **Print your resumes ahead of time:** at a minimum, have one for each company you plan to talk to and a couple extra. Printers will be available on the days of the Career Fair, but you will likely have a longer wait time.
- **Bring a notepad:** this will be extremely helpful especially if you're talking to multiple companies; you can keep notes that you prepared ahead of time as well as write new notes post-conversation.
- **Dress to impress:** what you're wearing is the recruiter's first impression of you. For more tips, visit Page 7.

During the Career Fair

- **Start with a company you're less interested in:** use the lower-pressure environment to practice and get comfortable.
- **During the conversation:**
 - Start with a strong handshake. Maintain eye contact and sound engaged.
 - Get the recruiter's contact information if possible, but don't be pushy about it and make sure you have a real reason.
 - Ask them if the role(s) you're interested in are available at certain locations, which shows you've done your research and also is valuable if location matters to you.
 - Be interested in the recruiter themselves! Ask questions about their career and what advice they'd give to their younger selves.
 - For more ideas on what to ask, read Page 8.
- **After the conversation:**
 - Write down the recruiter's name! Remembering that can give you an advantage later on for follow-ups, interviews, etc.
 - Take notes on what was discussed.
 - Reflect on what you did well and what you could improve on. Did you ask all of the questions you wanted to ask? How was your tone of voice?

After the Career Fair

- **Follow up with recruiters:** if you got a recruiter's contact information/wrote down their name, send them an email or LinkedIn request with a kind message reminding them who you are/what you discussed, and reiterate your interest in the role(s) their company offers.
- **Apply for roles:** if you didn't prior, apply to the roles you're interested in as well as any you learned of from the recruiters.
- **Prepare for interviews:** it's never too early to start practicing for interviews. More tips can be found on Page 9.

Elevator Pitch Guidelines

An elevator pitch is a 30–45 second introduction of you, your accomplishments, and your career goals. Make sure to include the following information in your elevator pitch:

- **Who are you?** (name, class, major)
- **What are you looking for?** (full-time, co-op, internship)
- **Why are you interested in the company?** (roles, location, mission, personal interests)
- **What do you have to offer?** (relevant experience, skills and strengths)
- **Ask a focused question** (tailored to the company)

General tips:

- Tailor the pitch to the company, including relevant skills and projects.
- Don't emphasize your classes too much. Everyone has taken/will take the same core set of classes. Mention side projects if you have them, and discuss class projects only if they weren't standardized across all students.
- Practice with friends, stuffed animals, and AI chatbots, but don't over-practice to the point where it sounds unnatural.
 - AI can be good for coming up with follow-up questions that recruiters may ask!
- We will have a drop-in practice room available in the Dude Connector for last-minute practice and feedback!

Examples:

"Hello, my name is [NAME] and I'm a sophomore studying electrical engineering. I'm seeking a summer internship in a customer-focused industry. In my intro-engineering design course, I worked together with a team of students to design, build, and test an autonomously operated quadcopter. I also currently work as an engineering tour leader where I engage with a variety of prospective students each week. Through my experiences, I have developed a strong collaborative spirit. I know your company culture emphasizes cross-functional teamwork and customer-focused design. Could you tell me more about how you've experienced this aspect of your company's culture in your daily work?"

"Hello, I'm [NAME] and I'm a senior studying materials science and engineering graduating this May. I am seeking a full-time position in product development. I recently interned at Ford where I led a project to evaluate the mechanical performance of a new material by planning and executing a variety of feasibility tests. On campus, I serve as a student leader in the Michigan Marching Band, where I help band members execute successful performances each week. I think my passion for technical challenges and leadership have prepared me well for a full-time opportunity at your company. I recently applied for an entry product engineering role on your company's website. Would you be able to tell me more about the role?"



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Resume Tips

Be sure to have physical and digital versions of your most recent resume. Most employers spend less than a minute looking at your resume, so keep it clear and concise. We recommend including the impact of your actions in your bullet points!

If you are applying for positions in different industries, consider tailoring your resume to each job. Be sure to check 12twenty to see what companies are accepting physical resumes.

Check out the [ECRC's website](#) for more detailed resume writing tips.

Dress Code

It is important to make a good first impression on employers. Dressing business casual (at a minimum) is a great way to accomplish this. Here are some tips on how to dress:

- Accessories: Ties are not required
- Tops: Collared shirts (polos, button-ups), sweaters, and blouses
- Bottoms: Slacks, khakis, and knee-length or longer skirts
- Dresses: Knee-length or longer dresses
- Shoes: Closed toed shoes
- Hair: Away from your face

Tip: wear something unique! Whether it's a dress shirt with a rarer pattern or a special hair clip, anything to stand out to recruiters (in a good way) can be helpful.

If you need clothes, check out the [Clothes Closet](#) at the University Career Center which allows you to pick out three articles of clothing. Registration is required before going in-person.

Questions to ask Recruiters

Role-related

- On a typical day, what does [role] do?
- What is the typical work week of a new college hire/intern?
- Will I be expected to work overtime? Travel?
- What sort of educational background do you look for in a candidate?
- What skills, abilities, and personal attributes are essential to success in your job/this field?
- Can you suggest anyone else I could contact for additional information?

Hiring Process/Next Steps

- What kind of person is most successful at [company]?
- Can you tell me a little bit about the different stages in the hiring process for [role]?
- What does the hiring process for [role] look like?
- How can I improve my chances of receiving a job offer?
- What would be a great next step to take after meeting you here?
- What's the best way to stay in touch with you?

Company Culture/Recruiter

- How long have you been with the organization?
- What do you like about [company]?
- What do you really enjoy about this role in particular?
- Why did you choose to work here?
- How did you become interested in this field?
- How did you begin your career?
- Is there something that surprised you about your role when you first started out in this career (or role)?
- What's your favorite thing about your job?
- What are some of the challenges you've faced in your role at [company]?
- What does growth and development look like at [company]?
- What makes your company different from other companies in your industry?
- What kind of culture is there around feedback at [company]? How do people like to give and receive feedback?
- What does communication look like at [company]?

Advice

- What steps would you recommend I take to prepare to be successful in this field?
- What current issues and trends in the field should I know about/be aware of?
- What advice would you give someone who is considering this type of job (or field)?

Interview Tips

Talk to friends about the types of interview questions they have had in the past. If you feel comfortable with a friend, have them ask you some questions and give you feedback.

Alternatively/additionally, record yourself answering practice questions. It can feel painful to watch the videos back, but it will be extremely helpful.

Here is a list of some of the most common interview questions that interviewers ask. Prepare yourself by thinking of how you would answer these beforehand.

- Why are you interested in working for our company?
- Where do you see yourself in 5 years? 10 years?
- Tell me about a time you had a conflict with a peer/co-worker. How was this resolved?
- When have you made a mistake and how did you react?
- How do you handle pressure?
- Tell me about your leadership experiences.
- What are your strengths and weaknesses?
- What questions do you have for me?

Sites like Glassdoor.com can be a great resource to learn about companies and their interview techniques. Then you will know if you should be expecting a technical or behavioral interview and you can prepare accordingly.

Companies can ask you curve-ball questions that you aren't ready for. Remember, don't panic. Most of the time they are just trying to see your thought process. Ask questions if necessary before answering, and don't be afraid to collect your thoughts before speaking.

At the end of the interview, don't be afraid to ask about the next steps in the company's hiring process. It gives you peace of mind in terms of when you will hear back about the job, and further shows your interest to the interviewer!